

China Logistics Note — Source List

Companion to: *China Logistics: Two Decades in One Note* (revised version, September 2026)

The first draft of the note drew on roughly 32 sources. The revised version — which added India comparators throughout and expanded the state-investment and demand-density sections — draws on the 58 below. Chinese-language sources are marked **[CN]**. Primary filings and official statistics are marked **[PRIMARY]**.

1. Chinese express industry — volumes, prices, revenue

#	Supports	Link
1	[PRIMARY] [CN] State Post Bureau FY2025: 199.0bn express parcels (+13.6%), 216.5bn postal items, express revenue RMB1.5tn	https://www.chinanews.com.cn/cj/2026/01-22/10557017.shtml
2	[CN] Dec 2025 monthly data; 2025 average unit revenue RMB7.63; full-year industry totals	https://36kr.com/p/3661076410672009
3	[CN] 2025 all-industry average price RMB7.51, down from RMB8.02	https://finance.sina.com.cn/jjxw/2026-04-23/doc-inhvtfe3800816.shtml
4	[CN] FY2024 industry: 175.08bn parcels (+21.5%), revenue RMB1.4tn; carrier volume ranking	https://news.qq.com/rain/a/20250122A08RT700
5	[CN] FY2024 carrier league table and unit revenue divergence	https://www.nbd.com.cn/articles/2025-01-27/3738264.html
6	[CN] FY2022 unit revenue by carrier: SF 15.73, YTO 2.59, Yunda 2.55, STO 2.52, ZTO 1.34	https://zhuanlan.zhihu.com/p/641739686

2. Demand density — the Yangtze Delta and Greater Bay Area

#	Supports	Link
7	[CN] FY2025 provincial volumes: Guangdong 46.0bn (23% of national), Zhejiang 34.4bn, Jiangsu 15.8bn; Guangdong's 27 logistics parks, 94 processing centres, 19,000+ village stations	https://m.10jqka.com.cn/20260129/c674413381.shtml
8	[CN] Same dataset, 21st Century Business Herald	https://www.21jingji.com/article/20260129/herald/c31c970dfcd62884cf483b429e36a11b.html
9	[CN] FY2024 city rankings: Guangzhou 14.25bn; Guangdong holds 5 of top 10 and 9 of top 50 cities	https://www.yicai.com/news/102449105.html
10	[CN] FY2023 top-10 cities; Jinhua (Yiwu) 13.69bn, the largest parcel city in China	https://www.21jingji.com/article/20240129/herald/aa58a85dd0e09571226caab129a4cc62.html
11	[CN] Provincial and city	https://www.jiemian.com/article/10769442.html

distribution of parcel volume

3. Tongda origins and franchise structure

#	Supports	Link
12	[PRIMARY] ZTO F-1 (2016): formal definition of the “Tongda Operators”, the network-partner model, and 2015 market shares	https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1677250/000091205716000640/filename1.htm
13	Tonglu Gang history, the 1993 founding of both STO and SF, franchise mechanics	https://pandayoo.com/post/sf-express-how-wang-wei-built-a-chinese-logistics-behemoth-from-backpacks-to-boeings/

4. Carrier financials and unit economics

#	Supports	Link
14	[PRIMARY] ZTO FY2025 results, 6-K Exhibit 99.1 — full P&L and unit cost detail	https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1677250/000110465926030007/tm269230d1_ex99-1.htm
15	[PRIMARY] ZTO FY2018 results — historical line-haul and sorting cost lines	https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1677250/000110465919015351/a19-6586_1ex99d1.htm
16	[CN] FY2025 leg-level unit costs: STO RMB1.98 (pickup+delivery 1.27 / sorting 0.31 / transport 0.39), ZTO RMB0.94, J&T China USD0.28	https://www.huxiu.com/article/4862999.html
17	[PRIMARY] [CN] YTO FY2025 annual report summary, CNINFO	http://dataclouds.cninfo.com.cn/shgongggao/hsomarket/2026/20260422/fa3d52a190e54e3aae4a020d7823ec47.PDF
18	[CN] YTO FY2025 unit transport RMB0.37 and unit hub operating RMB0.27	https://stock.stockstar.com/IG2026042200052531.shtml
	[CN] YTO	

19	FY2024 volume 26.573bn, express revenue RMB60.9bn, segment gross margins	https://www.stcn.com/article/detail/1734116.html
20	[PRIMARY] [CN] Yunda FY2025 annual report summary, SZSE	https://disc.static.szse.cn/disc/disk03/finalpage/2026-04-25/f6ea5552-0a7b-4f6c-a787-b4962bdf81ed.PDF
21	[CN] Yunda FY2025: revenue RMB51,475mn, net profit RMB1,171mn (-38.79%)	https://finance.cnr.cn/ycbd/20260425/t20260425_527599983.shtml
22	[CN] FY2023 leg-level unit costs: Yunda RMB2.10 (transport 0.50 / sorting 0.37 / delivery fee 1.21), YTO 2.18, STO 2.15, J&T China USD0.34	https://news.qq.com/rain/a/20240501A06UW400
23	[PRIMARY] [CN] SF Holding FY2025 annual report summary, CNINFO	https://static.cninfo.com.cn/finalpage/2026-03-31/1225057386.PDF
24	[CN] SF FY2025 segment revenue split; time-definite RMB131.0bn, economy RMB32.1bn	https://finance.sina.com.cn/roll/2026-04-02/doc-inhtaeni7966118.shtml
25	[CN] SF FY2025 gross margin 13.32%, volume 16.72bn tickets	https://basic.10jqka.com.cn/002352/worth.html
26	[CN] SF volume definition (速运 物流业务量 16.63bn)	https://finance.sina.com.cn/wm/2026-04-09/doc-inhtwxnx5860765.shtml
27	[PRIMARY] J&T Express FY2025 operating metrics: 30.13bn parcels	https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/jt-express-hits-record-30-billion-parcel-volume-in-2025-with-22-2-yoy-growth-302654411.html

	(+22.2%)	
28	[PRIMARY] J&T FY2025 annual results: revenue USD12.2bn, segment EBIT, China cost/parcel USD0.28	https://www.barchart.com/story/news/1035784/jt-express-reports-18-5-yoy-revenue-growth-for-fy2025-new-markets-achieve-full-year-profitability-for-the-first-time
29	[CN] J&T segment detail: China 22.07bn parcels, SEA unit economics, New Markets	https://finance.sina.com.cn/roll/2026-04-01/doc-inhsxeis2263451.shtml

5. Platform-carrier interplay and the Alibaba unwind

#	Supports	Link
30	[CN] Alibaba divesting Tongda stakes; Cainiao's domestic supply chain folded into Taobao/Tmall; Cainiao IPO withdrawal	https://36kr.com/p/3892406243129985
31	[CN] YTO stake sale detail; Alibaba's Yunda holding cut from 2% (2023) to 0.71% (1H25)	https://36kr.com/p/3661076410672009
32	[CN] Cainiao sells Danniao to STO for RMB362mn; Danniao FY2024 revenue RMB12.35bn	https://m.thepaper.cn/detail/31247916
33	[CN] Danniao deal analysis; STO share rising from 12.98% to 13.5%	https://www.sohu.com/a/919456023_122014422
34	[CN] Alibaba's historical stakes: STO ~25%, ZTO ~8.9%, Yunda 2%, Best >30%	https://zhuanlan.zhihu.com/p/30704227791
35	[CN] Alibaba's investment timeline in YTO (2015, 2020), ZTO (2018), STO (2019)	https://app.myzaker.com/article/6a54cde48e9f090c75398f46

6. Infrastructure and modal mix

#	Supports	Link
36	[PRIMARY] [CN] Ministry of Transport 2025 Statistical Bulletin — expressways 199,400 km, HSR 50,400 km, total rail 165,000 km, freight volume by mode. The single best source for section 5 and 7 of the note.	https://xxgk.mot.gov.cn/jigou/zhghs/202606/t20260618_4207752.html
37	[CN] Coverage of the same bulletin	https://www.chinanews.com.cn/cj/2026/06-22/10645076.shtml
38	[CN] HSR grew from 37,900 km to 50,400 km over the 14th Five-Year Plan (+32.98%)	https://finance.sina.com.cn/tech/roll/2026-01-05/doc-inhfthick6688932.shtml

7. State logistics-cost policy

#	Supports	Link

39	[PRIMARY] [CN] Full text of the <i>Action Plan for Effectively Reducing Society-Wide Logistics Costs</i> (Nov 2024)	https://www.mee.gov.cn/zcwj/zyygwj/202411/t20241128_1097450.shtml
40	[PRIMARY] [CN] State Council policy interpretation of the Action Plan	https://www.gov.cn/zhengce/202411/content_6989663.htm
41	[CN] Ratio fell 18% (2012) → 14.4% (2023); 13.5% target by 2027; >RMB1tn implied savings; explicit statement that the goal is not to compress company profits or worker incomes	https://sd.spb.gov.cn/sdsyzglj/c100065/c100067/202412/b2eb79a6195f46d7a3e8dc64160bbe5b.shtml
42	[CN] Structure: 5 task areas, 20 tasks, 110+ policy points	https://www.yicai.com/news/102378278.html
43	[CN] 2027 targets for rail freight volume (~11%) and turnover (~23%) share	https://fgw.wuhan.gov.cn/xwzx/mtgz/202411/t20241128_2491080.html
44	[CN] Qiushi summary of the Action Plan	https://www.qstheory.cn/qshyjx/2024-11/28/c_1130223618.htm
45	[PRIMARY] [CN] State Council Information Office press briefing materials	http://www.scio.gov.cn/live/2024/35153/gwxz/202411/P020241129369718741261.pdf

8. China's internet ecosystem

#	Supports	Link
46	[PRIMARY] [CN] CNNIC 57th Statistical Report (data to Dec 2025): 1.125bn users, 80.1% penetration, mobile 99.6%, rural 314mn (27.9%), online shopping 937mn (83.2%), food delivery 630mn, social 1.114bn	https://finance.sina.com.cn/tech/roll/2026-03-17/doc-inhrfshc8397107.shtml
47	[CN] Same report: online shopping users 937mn, annual spend RMB1.94tn	https://www.bjnews.com.cn/detail/1776935530019764.html
48	[CN] CNNIC 57th report, full-text download page	https://www.100ec.cn/detail--6657847.html

9. India comparators — logistics cost and modal mix

#	Supports	Link
	[PRIMARY] NCAER <i>Logistics Cost in</i>	

49	India: Assessment and Long-Term Framework — the methodology behind the revised estimate	https://ncaer.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/12/NCAER_Report_LogisticsCost2023.pdf
50	[PRIMARY] DPIIT publication of the NCAER assessment	https://www.dpiit.gov.in/static/uploads/2025/07/b6c9db15ce083fd10caa9787bf8a281f.pdf
51	NCAER–DPIIT FY24: logistics cost ₹24.01 lakh crore = 7.97% of GDP, 9.09% of non-services output	https://www.freightfox.ai/industry-insights/freightfox-insight-brief-indias-logistics-cost-landscape
52	Original 7.8–8.9% FY22 estimate and the downward revision from the older 13–14% narrative	https://www.business-standard.com/amp/economy/news/india-s-logistics-cost-between-7-8-and-8-9-of-gdp-in-fy22-ncaer-123121401099_1.html
53	Road at ~65% of Indian freight; rail ₹1.96 vs road ₹3.78 per tonne-km; SME 16.9% vs large-firm 7.6% logistics cost	https://infra.tractorjunction.com/en/news/india-logistics-costs-fall-to-9-percent-by-2025

10. India comparators — internet and carriers

#	Supports	Link
54	IAMAI–Kantar <i>Internet in India 2025</i> : 950mn+ users, rural 57% of base (548mn), 38% still non-users	https://www.business-standard.com/industry/news/indian-internet-user-base-crosses-950-million-in-2025-iamai-report-126012901048_1.html
55	Same report: 230mn urban online shoppers (56% of urban active base), 193mn multi-device users	https://bestmediainfo.com/insights/indias-internet-users-near-one-billion-in-2025-rural-india-leads-growth-iamai-11056899
56	India e-commerce market size ~\$147.3bn (2024)	https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/E-commerce_in_India
57	[PRIMARY] Shadowfax Q4 FY26 investor presentation — the full cost stack used for the India leg-level decomposition	https://www.medianama.com/wp-content/uploads/2026/05/Shadowfax_Q4FY26_Earnings_Presentation.pdf
58	Delhivery FY26 results — 1bn parcels, express revenue ₹6,685cr	https://www.itln.in/amp/logistics/delhivery-posts-105-billion-fy26-revenue-turns-cashflow-positive-1359229

Also drawn on, without public links

- **Delhivery Q4 FY26 earnings call** — Transport Service EBITDA 15.6%, ROIC 16.0%, express margin at the upper end of 16–18% normative guidance. https://finance.yahoo.com/quote/DELHIVERY.BO/earnings/DELHIVERY.BO-Q4-2026-earnings_call-546283.html
- **Meesho earnings transcripts, Feb / May / Jul 2026** — held in this project's knowledge base. Used for the Valmo capacity unwind, the VTPL/GTA restructuring, and insourcing mix commentary.
- **JM Financial initiation on Meesho (Jan 2026)** — ₹59.1 per order charged to sellers, ₹41 logistics and fulfilment cost per order in 1H FY26. https://bsmedia.business-standard.com/_media/bs/data/market-reports/equity-brokers/tips/2026-01/17679504020.34145800.pdf
- **Upstox / Meesho IPO analysis** — Valmo 763.51mn shipped orders in FY25 (48% of shipped), 64.5% in 1H FY26. <https://upstox.com/news/market-news/ipo/meesho-ipo-these-three-key-factors-set-meesho-apart-from-flipkart-and-amazon-india/article-185590/>
- **Ekart FY25 RoC filing coverage** — revenue ₹13,732.9cr, net loss ₹1,515cr. <https://inc42.com/buzz/flipkarts-logistics-arm-ekart-narrows-fy25-loss-to-inr-1515-cr/>

- **Blue Dart FY26 investor presentation** — 404mn shipments, revenue ₹6,141cr, EBITDA ₹649.2cr. <https://www.earningscanvas.in/company/BLUEDART/Q1-FY2027>
 - **Xpressbees FY25 RoC filing coverage** — revenue ₹2,874cr, net loss ₹370cr. <https://www.cbinsights.com/company/xpressbees>
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Notes on source quality

Where I'd want a second look before publishing. Three figures in the note rest on secondary Chinese-language analysis rather than the filings themselves: STO's RMB1.27 unit pickup-and-delivery cost, J&T China's cost split, and Yunda's derived RMB1.85 unit total cost. All three come from sources 16 and 22. They are internally consistent and cross-check against each other, but if any of them is going into something published, confirm against the companies' own 年报 on CNINFO first.

The strongest sources in the set are 36 (MOT statistical bulletin), 39 and 41 (the Action Plan and its official interpretation), 46 (CNNIC), 14 and 15 (ZTO's SEC filings) and 57 (Shadowfax's investor deck). Those six carry most of the load in the note and are all primary.

On the India logistics-cost comparison. Sources 49–52 are the reason the note flags that comparison so heavily. India's official figure of 7.97% of GDP and China's 13.9% are not measured the same way, and quoting them side by side without that caveat would produce a misleading conclusion.